



Foldable batteries

It battery can be folded, twisted, and stretched without interrupting the supply of power. <https://digit.in/oct19-13>



Amazon wearables

The company has announced an Alexa-enabled ring (Echo Loop) and glasses (Echo Frame). <https://digit.in/oct19-14>

since he provided a working system that people could actually use now. The entire cypherpunk movement was reinforced since Bitcoin now enabled organisations such as WikiLeaks to continue operating via Bitcoin donations, despite the traditional financial system cutting them off.

Bitcoin, until this point, had actually been exchanged only once - in January 2009, Nakamoto sent Hal Finney, a cypherpunk and computer programmer, 10 Bitcoin. Other than this transaction, Bitcoin was basically just being mined and determining its monetary value was impossible. Following this, an individual named Laszlo Hanyecz made the first real-world Bitcoin transaction by swapping 10,000 Bitcoin for 2 pizzas. Boy, those were some expensive pizzas if we were going by the current Bitcoin exchange rate. Currently, there are over 16 million Bitcoins in circulation which generate a total market capitalization of over \$50 billion. At its peak, one Bitcoin amounted to over \$20,000 USD, which is staggering.

RIVAL CRYPTOCURRENCIES EMERGE

With the inflating popularity of Bitcoin since 2009, several other cryptocurrencies have also come into existence. As of August 2018, there were over 1600 cryptocurrencies being traded across the globe. Litecoin, Dash, Ripple, ZCash, and Monero are some popular examples. These alternatives to Bitcoin were also dubbed

'altcoin' and many of them attempt to improve the original design of Bitcoin by offering better speed, anonymity and other such advantages. In total, the market capitalization is over \$100 billion and this amount is larger than the GDP of 127 countries! As a result of this astounding growth, cryptocurrency trading be-



Ethereum proved to be a solid competitor to Bitcoin

came the new rage and emerged globally. In 2013, Bitcoin prices crashed significantly after reaching a high of \$1000 USD to one Bitcoin.

Soon after, a cryptocurrency which came extremely close to stealing Bitcoin's thunder - Ethereum - made its way into the market. It was proposed in 2013 and went live in July 2015. An open-source, blockchain-based computing platform, Ethereum displayed tremendous potential and received unwavering support from hoards of developers, users and businesses. This

open-source blockchain project even enables startups to develop cryptocurrencies of their own, built on the Ethereum platform.

THE FALL AND SUBSEQUENT RISE AGAIN

The hype caused by cryptocurrency, especially Bitcoin, led to a few moments of unprecedented success and then a massive fall. Bitcoin dropped from \$20,000 USD to a meagre \$3,000 USD in 2018. This unstable condition caused many newcomers to back off, with some fleeing the market altogether. However, with lesser people crowding the space, regulators, as well as enterprises, were now able to focus on what they deemed to be the most important thing about cryptocurrency, which was its underlying technology, blockchain.

Companies such as IBM, Microsoft, Amazon and more began building blockchain divisions, and even banks, who were once true sceptics, began hiring blockchain engineers. Regulators believed that blockchain and digital tokens had a ton of value and could be separated from scams and hacks that are often seen in ICO markets. In early 2019, a few cryptocurrencies began gaining momentum yet again. The public's interest also returned, and this time around the technology was backed by big institutionalised money. The media even labelled the first quarter of 2019 as the 'Cryptocurrency Spring'. Bitcoin passed the \$12,000 USD mark yet again (however, it is fluctuating around \$8-10K now) and returned in the good graces of the public.

Regulation and the support from legitimate establishments has enabled the cryptocurrency market to become steadier and a more reliable space for companies and new technologies to flourish. However, there are still some hurdles such as over-regulation by governments around the world that can still prove as a deterrent to cryptocurrencies success in the long run. For now, users having a bit of cryptocurrency left over from its golden days have a solid cause to celebrate. 



Altcoin or cryptocurrencies other than Bitcoin